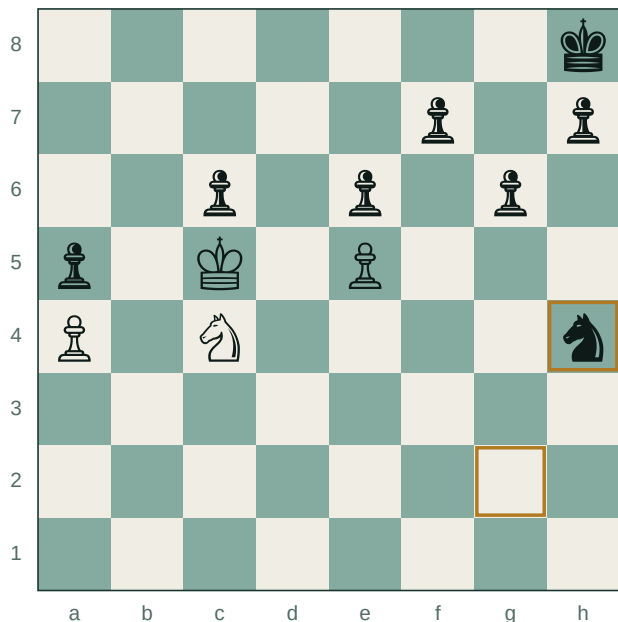


# Knight-ending routes: White, move 47

Knight-ending routes

White to move



Previous move: 46...Nxh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**47. Nxa5 Nf3 48. Nxc6**

**47.Nxa5** The knight captures the pawn on a5. Recorded reply: **47...Nf3**.

**48.Nxc6** The knight captures the pawn on c6.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from -4 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Knight endings reward exact route calculation. Forks can change a pawn race, while a distant passer may outrun the knight's short-range movement.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: knight on h4. Check for tactical protection.